

CHENG ZENG

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Research Interests

Multimodal and Spatial Interaction in XR; AI-Assisted 3D Authoring; VR for Wellbeing; VR Tools for Behavioral Research

Education

Harvard University Graduate School of Design

Master in Architecture II 2016.9–2018.5

- Coursework: Architecture Design Studios; Digital Media; Digital Design and Fabrication; Design Across Scales, Disciplines and Problem Contexts (MIT); Design Studio: Information and Visualization (MIT).

Rhode Island School of Design

Bachelor of Architecture and Bachelor of Fine Arts 2012.6–2015.5

- Coursework: Architecture Design Studios; Structural Analysis; Perception and Mind (Brown University).

University of Hong Kong

Enrolled in Bachelor of Arts in Architectural Studies Program; transferred to RISD 2011.9–2012.6

Preparatory Studies in Engineering at Zhejiang University 2010.9–2011.7

- Coursework: Advanced Mathematics; Critical Thinking.

Publications

Cheng Zeng, Qinrong Liu, and Pengcheng An. 2026. HeriTell: Supporting Interactive Documentation of Cultural Heritage Knowledge through Spatial Authoring. *CHI EA '26*. DOI: 10.1145/3772363.3798478.

Qinrong Liu*, **Cheng Zeng***, and Dajun Yao. 2026. Flux Tower: An Immersive Point-Cloud Journey through Asian Urban Density. *VINCI '26, Media Gallery*. Accepted for exhibition. (*Equal contribution.)

Dan Li, Zhiqi Luo, Shanshan Han, and **Cheng Zeng**. 2026. Empowering Local Cultural Communication through AI Visualization of Oral History: A Case Study of an AI-Driven, Scaffolding-Based Knowledge-Base Teaching Model. *Mass Literature (Dazhong Wenyi)*, no. 18, 146–148. [In Chinese.] DOI: 10.20112/j.cnki.ISSN1007-5828.2026.18.047.

Academic Experience

Shenzhen Technology University, School of Design and Innovation

Lecturer, Department of Environmental Design 2023.12–present

- Teaching core design studios and technology courses in Environmental and New Media Art, including: Site and Spatial Design Studio, Advanced Digital Design Technologies, Creative Coding.
- Supervising undergraduate theses exploring responsive environments and XR space design.
- Developed practice-based studio projects addressing local community needs; led “Yuexi Plaza Landscape Revitalization” project which received Provincial Award for County Planning & Design Excellence (2024).

Project Lead, University-funded Pedagogical Research Project 2025.1–present

- Institutionally funded project integrating AIGC, VR/AR, and interactive media into real-site design studios.

Digital Futures Workshop, Tongji University

2025

- **Orchestrating Chaos**—Collaborative exploration of LLM-agent-augmented generative design using reclaimed materials.

Awards and Exhibitions

Shenzhen & Hong Kong Bi-City Biennale of Urbanism/Architecture Exhibition 2025

- Asteroid-Linked Nexus—a Sci-Fi space dwelling scene concept; featured in Off-World Theater CAVE VR.
- Cloud Tower—an interactive VR experience inviting visitors to ascend an octagonal ancient tower, encounter East Asian urban density, and trace video-to-point-cloud visual transformation; featured in Paradox SCENE.

Third Prize, National Teaching Innovation Competition in Art & Design Education (“Future Designer 2024”, Nationwide Final Round) 2024

- Site & Spatial Design Studio Empowering Rural Revitalization in Luhe County—team award; served as the main instructor guiding project design and presentation.

Honorable Mention, Non-Architecture Unbuilt Project Award 2022

- Trace-S—a memorial park for Korea’s 416 ferry disaster (team award; contributed as main designer).

Top 3 Finalist, Urban Confluence Silicon Valley International Competition 2020

- The Nebula Tower—a landmark building and landscape design for San Jose (team award; contributed to early concept discussions and final design refinement).

Digital Design and Fabrication Exhibition, Harvard GSD 2018

- Spaceramic—collaborative digitally-fabricated ceramic work, Harvard Ceramic Lab Exhibition.

Professional Experience

China Resources Land, Shenzhen Region 2021.4–2023.4

Senior Project Supervisor

- 2022 Educational Architecture Research Program—led a research initiative on educational environment design in Shenzhen, responsible for framework, survey data collection and presentation of findings.
- Chuangxing K-9 School New Campus—coordinated multi-stakeholder delivery across all phases.

Sasaki Associates 2018.9–2020.8

Architectural Designer

- University of Lima Innovation Center (Peru)—Contributed from concept through construction documentation; project received SCUP Excellence in Architecture for a New Building Merit Award.
- Xinyang University Academic Center (China)—Actively participated on concept through schematic design for a 40,000 m² academic building; In charge of coordination with client and local consultant.

Skills

Programming & Interactive Media: Unity (C#), Python, Processing, TouchDesigner, Arduino, AR/VR Prototyping, Web Development

3D Design & Scene Processing: Rhino, Grasshopper, Revit, Scene Rendering

Digital Fabrication: Laser Cutting, 3D Printing, CNC